



Though a good universal remote, the companion combo doesn't offer good value for money

270,000 devices straight out of the box, most of which are Blu-ray players and set-top boxes. The main problem with the device is that it doesn't support ZigBee and Z-Wave technologies, which makes it useless for a large part of the smart device market dominated by appliances using these standards. Though you can buy an additional extender sold

by Logitech that makes it compatible with the above standards, it brings up the overall cost of the device.

Insteon 2245-222 Central Controller Hub

Insteon is another popular smart device manufacturer in the constantly evolving and rapidly growing home automation technology market. It has its own range of smart devices and recently came out with its own hub. It is one of the few smart hubs that comes with an app for your PC. The hub is compatible with

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Insteon offers a wide range of smart devices for home automation

all the Insteon smart devices, and a variety of other smart devices like the Nest Learning Thermostat and the Amazon Echo but it offers no support for Z-Wave and ZigBee devices, so until and unless you are setting up a smart home from scratch or have an all Insteon smart devices setup, there are better options available in the market.

Amazon Echo, Echo Dot, Tap (Powered by Alexa)

Amazon recently expanded its smart portable speakers range with the new Echo Dot and Tap, all of which are powered by its AI assistant Alexa.